MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,
RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee
RECALLING ALSO its adoption, by resolution A.864(20), of the Recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships , and by resolution A.1050(27), of the Revised recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships , incorporating therein recommendations for entering cargo spaces, tanks, pump-rooms, fuel tanks, cofferdams, duct keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,
RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and
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SOURCE: MSC.581(110).pdf
URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.581(110).pdf
keels, ballast tanks and similar enclosed spaces,
RECALLING FURTHER that SOLAS regulation III/19.3.6 requires enclosed space entry and rescue drills, SOLAS regulation XI-1/7 requires the carrying of atmosphere testing instrument for enclosed spaces, and SOLAS chapter IX and the ISM Code require management for the safe operation of ships,
RECALLING that the Maritime Safety Committee is requested to keep the revised recommendations under review and amend them as necessary,
BEING CONCERNED about the continued loss of life resulting from personnel entering shipboard spaces in which the atmosphere is unable to support life, owing to oxygen depletion, oxygen enrichment, toxicity or flammability,
BEING AWARE of the work undertaken in this regard by the International Labour Organization, Governments and segments of the private sector,
RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful
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Governments and segments of the private sector,
RECOGNIZING that organizational leadership plays a crucial role in successful implementation of this guidance by empowering shipboard staff to make the right decisions,
HAVING CONSIDERED , at its 110th session, the recommendation made by the Sub-Committee on Carriage of Cargoes and Containers at its tenth session,
1 ADOPTS the Revised recommendations for entering enclosed spaces aboard ships, as set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2 INVITES Governments to bring the annexed Revised Recommendations to the attention of shipowners, ship operators, seafarers, port and terminal operators and port workers, urging them to apply them, as appropriate, to all ships and operations;
3 INVITES the Assembly to revoke resolution A.1050(27) and to endorse the action taken by the Maritime Safety Committee.
RESOLUTION MSC.581(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025)
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING
ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS

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REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING
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ANNEX
REVISED RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENTERING
ENCLOSED SPACES ABOARD SHIPS
Preamble
The objective of these recommendations is to encourage the adoption of safety procedures and the development of sound practices aimed at preventing casualties to, and enhancing the safety of, personnel entering or working in enclosed spaces where there may be an oxygen-deficient, oxygen-enriched, flammable and/or toxic atmosphere. Additionally, in the event of an emergency within an enclosed space, these recommendations provide guidance for an appropriate, planned and considered response complying with ship-specific enclosed space rescue plans.
Investigations into the circumstances of enclosed space accidents have shown that a failure to
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